

though many point to the bailout of Cyprus and the associated losses that citizens took on their bank account balances as the core driver. Bitcoin received ample interest for being outside of government control, making its holders immune to such events. Bloomberg ran a story on March 25, 2013, with the eye-catching title, “Bitcoin May Be the Global Economy’s Last Safe Haven.”³

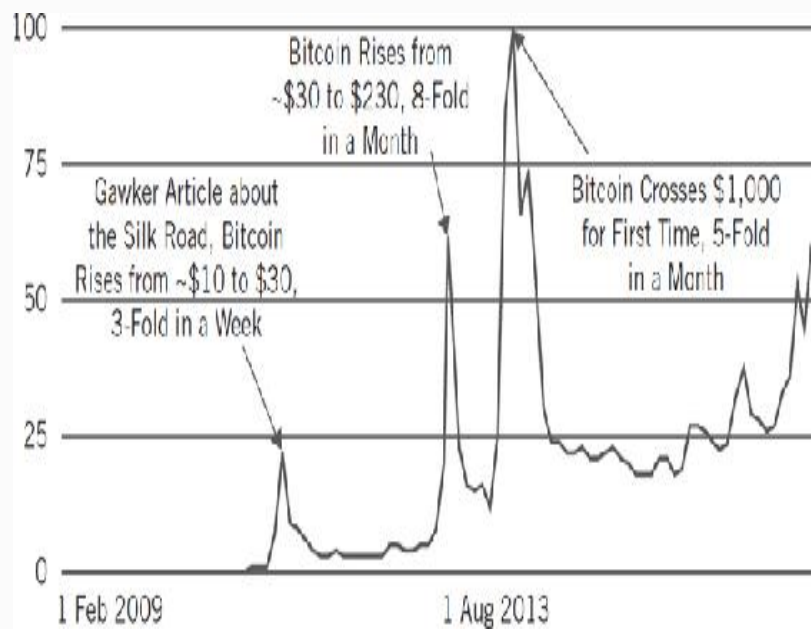


Figure 3.1 ■ Google search spikes for the term “bitcoin” Source: Annotation of Google Search screenshot

While the spring of 2013 was notable, it was a preview for bitcoin’s grand opening to global attention. This came six months later, in November 2013, when increased demand for bitcoin in China along with interest from the U.S. Senate on the innovation led to a stratospheric ascent through \$1,000 that grabbed international headlines.⁴